

Week 6 Cram Sheet

Night-Before Recall + Quick Reference

Lecture 6 · Lixing Lao, Ph.D., L.Ac., MB · Topic: Inspection — Vitality, Color, Sense Organs, Hair/Nails/Skin, Secretions, Pediatric Dx

1 · Framework	
Method	Uses
Inspection	Eyes: vitality, color, appearance, secretions (incl. tongue)
Auscult./Olfact.	Ears (listen) + nose (smell)
Inquiry	Verbal questioning
Palpation	Touch, incl. pulse

Quick Recall: Zang-Xiang = inside shows outside.

2 · Shen (Vitality)	
Finding	Meaning
Clear, sparkling eyes	Shen present
Dull, cloudy eyes	Shen disturbed

3 · Five Colors of Face	
Color	Indication
Red	Heat (excess=whole face; malar only=yin-def heat)
Pale/White	Cold, blood/yang deficiency
Yellow	Deficiency, damp (bright=yang jaundice/damp-heat; smoky=yin jaundice)
Blue-Green	Cold, pain, stagnation, convulsion
Dark Grey/Black	Kidney deficiency, blood stasis

Quick Recall: Lustrous=good prognosis. Dark/haggard=poor prognosis.

Heads Up — Homework format = 5-color comparison table w/ case example. Expect similar on quiz.

Secretions: Color Rule	
Finding	Meaning
Clear/white	Def./cold
Turbid/yellow	Excess/heat

4 · Appearance & Movement	
Finding	Pattern
Overweight + depression	Qi def. + phlegm-damp
Thin + dry skin	Blood insufficiency
Active movement	Yang syndrome
Passive manner	Yin syndrome
Muscle weakness/atrophy	Wei syndrome
Pain+swelling+restricted joints	Bi syndrome
One-sided numbness	Hemiplegia/wind-stroke
Tremors/convulsions	Wind
Stiffness/rigidity	Qi stag./blood stasis/wind

Quick Recall: Active/fast/hot=Yang excess. Passive/slow/cold=Yin deficiency.

5 · Eyes: Five Wheels		
Wheel	Structure	Organ
Blood	Inner/outer canthus	Heart
Qi	Sclera	Lung
Wind	Iris	Liver
Water	Pupil	Kidney
Flesh	Eyelids	Spleen/Stomach

Heads Up — Right Chi pulse = PC/San Jiao, NOT Kidney. Don't confuse w/ eye-wheel Kidney=pupil.

6 · Nose
Lung (5-phase) + Spleen (facial map, both Su Wen & Ling Shu).

Finding	Pattern
Green/blue tip	Cold
Yellow tip	Damp (+heat if thirst/sweat)
White tip	Blood deficiency
Red tip	Heat
Gray tip	Impaired water → edema
Green bridge	Liver Qi stagnation
Dark purple bridge	Blood stasis
Red bridge	Liver fire
Flaring nostrils	Extreme heat
Epistaxis	Excess heat, blood forced out
Swollen/Sunken nose	Excess/Deficiency

Edema Starts In	Organ
Upper body/head	Lung
Lower body/feet	Kidney
4 limbs/torso	Spleen

7 · Ears
Kidney opens to ear.

Finding	Pattern
Dry/withered/black auricle	Kidney essence exhausted
Purulent discharge	Damp-heat Liver/GB
Thin ear	Qi/Blood deficiency
Long full earlobes	Strong constitution
Small earlobes	Poor constitution
White/pale	Cold
Black	Kidney failure
Red	Excess heat

Tinnitus	Organ
High-pitch (cicada)	Liver
Low-pitch (water)	Kidney

8 · Teeth/Gums/Lips/Throat	
Teeth Finding	Pattern
White, moist, bright	Strong Kidney Qi
Dry, no sheen	Kidney Yin decline
Sudden dull yellow	Kidney deficiency
Gray/black	Yin+Yang exhaustion
Deviated growth	Insufficient Yangming Qi

Gums/Lips/Mouth	Pattern
Pale gums/lips	Blood deficiency
Deep red + swelling gums	Stomach fire
Purple lips	Blood stasis
Crimson lips	Yin-def. heat
Deviated mouth	Wind
Mouth remains open+fever	Excess heat
Mouth slightly open	Deficiency

Eye Color	Pattern
Yellow (bright)	Damp-heat, heat predom.
Red	Heart/Liver fire
Blue-green	Liver wind
Bluish	Internal cold / Kidney Yin def.
Dark/black sclera	Accumulated heat
White rings	Turbid phlegm
Eye Shape/Move	Pattern
Bulging/protruding	Liver Yang rising
Sunken	Lung/Spleen deficiency
Swollen, sudden	Fluid malfunction
Strabismus, sudden, no redness	Wind attacking channels
Ptosis (droopy lid)	Qi sinking or wind
Spasms + pale + thready pulse	Blood deficiency

Throat/Tonsils	Pattern
Acute red+swollen	Wind invasion (exterior)
Chronic red+swollen	Interior Stomach heat
Dry, NOT swollen, chronic	Lung/Kidney Yin def., empty heat

9 · Hair, Nails, Skin

Hair/Nails	Pattern
Premature graying	Kidney essence depletion
Dull, brittle hair	Liver Blood deficiency
Nail pink, blanch returns fast	Sufficient Qi/Blood
Blanch returns slow	Qi/Blood exhaustion
Ridged nails	Kidney Yin def./Liver Yang rising
Spoon-shaped nails	Qi/Blood stag., Spleen def.

Skin	Pattern
Yellow orangish	Damp-heat, heat > damp
Yellow dusky	Damp-heat, damp > heat
Pitting edema	Yang def. (Spleen/Kidney)
Non-pitting edema	Qi stagnation/dampness

10 · Secretions/Excretions Logic (applies to nasal d/c, sputum, stool, vaginal d/c)

Axis	Cold/Deficient	Hot/Excess
Color	White	Yellow
Consistency	Thin, clear, watery	Thick, sticky
Quantity	Profuse	Scanty
Odor	None/faint	Strong

11 · Infant Finger Venous Diagnosis (age <3)

Gate Reached	Severity	Side	Sex
Wind Gate only	Mild / exterior	Left index finger	Boys
Qi Gate	Interior, stronger	Right index finger	Girls
Life Gate	Severe	—	—
Past Life Gate to tip	Life-threatening	—	—

Vein Color	Indication
Light red	Normal
Bright red	Heat
Purple	Stronger heat/stasis
Green/dark blue	Wind

Heads Up — Prof. Lao stated directly: **"Nothing on the body constitutions"** will be tested. Skip Five-Element constitutional typing in your cram pass.